# Process Creation Investigation – hostname.exe

## Objective

The objective of this investigation is to verify that hostname.exe process execution events are successfully collected by Elastic SIEM using Sysmon logs. This investigation demonstrates how endpoint process activity can be monitored, validated, and analyzed to identify potentially suspicious or unauthorized system reconnaissance.

## Command Executed

```
hostname
```

## Detection Method (KQL)

```
process.args : "hostname"
```

This query was used because the environment indexed the command arguments rather than the executable name.

## Evidence Collected

**Timestamp:** 2026-07-20T16:14:01.763Z
**Process Name:** hostname.exe
**Host Name:** sepisecurity
**User Domain:** Sepisecurity
**Process ID (PID):** 11144
**Event Code:** 1 (Sysmon Process Creation)

## Analysis

The investigation confirmed that hostname.exe executed successfully on the monitored Windows endpoint. The event identified the user account, host system, process identifier, and execution time. The command was executed through a legitimate Windows administrative process and no unusual parent process, suspicious command-line arguments, or malicious behavior were observed. The activity is consistent with normal system administration and host identification.

## Security Impact

The hostname command is commonly used by administrators to identify a system. However, attackers also use it during the reconnaissance phase to collect host information before performing lateral movement or privilege escalation. Monitoring hostname execution enables SOC analysts to identify abnormal reconnaissance activity when combined with other suspicious events.

## Conclusion

This investigation demonstrates the ability to detect and analyze Windows process creation events using Elastic SIEM and Sysmon. The collected evidence indicates legitimate administrative activity, and no indicators of compromise were identified. The investigation also demonstrates practical skills in KQL searching, endpoint telemetry analysis, and security event documentation.